

Crispy Smashed Potatoes (Variation 14)

Tags: *side, vegan, gluten-free, dinner, comfort-food* | Prep: 10 min | Cook: 50 min | Serves: 8

Ingredients

- 1600 g baby potatoes (similar size)
- 6 tbsp olive oil
- 3 tsp fine salt
- 2 tsp garlic powder
- 2/2 tsp smoked paprika
- Black pepper
- fresh rosemary or rosemary (optional)
- Sour cream or aioli to serve

Method

1. Bring a large pot of well-salted water to a boil. Add potatoes and cook for 20–25 minutes until completely tender throughout.
2. Drain and allow to steam-dry for 5 minutes.
3. Preheat oven to 220 °C. Drizzle a large baking tray with half the olive oil.
4. Arrange potatoes on the tray with space between each. Using a flat-bottomed glass or potato masher, press down firmly on each potato to flatten to about 1 cm.
5. Drizzle with remaining oil. Sprinkle with salt, garlic powder, paprika, and pepper. Add herbs if using.
6. Roast for 25–30 minutes until golden and deeply crispy at the edges.
7. Serve with sour cream or aioli.

Chef Tips

- Boiling until completely tender is crucial — an undercooked potato won't smash properly.
- Space between potatoes on the tray is essential for crisping — use two trays if necessary.
- The crispiest results come from very hot oil hitting the potato bottom; preheat the tray for 5 minutes.